scholar reveals that 'no other foreign poet has been translated, studied, forgotten and resurrected in China as much as Tagore'.[61] A section of Chinese dissidents seems to particularly admire Gandhi, seeing in his political practice a non-violent pathway to opposing authoritarianism. A sculpture of him in a Beijing park, near the posh Palm Springs high-rises, gradually attracts more visitors including local schoolchildren who 'bring flowers' on Tomb Sweeping Day (Qingming Festival) to mark the beginning of spring but also to pay respect to ancestors.[62] Gandhi is not a Chinese ancestor, but he draws veneration.

Indian culture – its classical and popular culture – has its admirers. Yoga flourishes in China. The indebtedness to Buddhism still exists. It is probably the basis for the Chinese saying, which allegedly even Mao pronounced on occasion, 'If a man lived a good life then he would be reborn in India'.[63] A student, contrary to most of his peers, says, 'I like India. It has many things we never see in China or any country, and I think Hinduism is a very tolerant religion.'[64] Sa Dingding, a popular musician who 'promotes Sino-Indian fusion', charmingly and sincerely tells Patil, 'I believe I was a soul in ancient India in my past life. Everything in India feels so familiar.'[65] Sa has studied Tibetan and Sanskrit texts, but eagerly follows Indian popular culture – its films and contemporary music and dance – as well. She informs Patil that the 'melody and rhythm of ancient Indian music has influenced Chinese music and Buddhist chants'.[66]

Patil's interlocutors on the whole though are more interested in present-day India. Here and there, Indian democracy, economic advances, and social policy win plaudits. A student declares, 'In future, China will be a democratic nation. In this aspect, China should learn from India's experience.'[67] The Anna Hazare campaign against corruption in India catches the eye: 'How come there's no one like Hazare in China? Look forward to that!'[68] India's new economy also garners admirers. A vice president of the China Institute of International Studies sees progress over twenty–twenty-five years since a visit he made in 1990.[69] The resilience and capabilities of Indians impress. One interlocutor confesses, 'We in China often wonder why Indians look happy . . . even those who are not so rich.'[70]